

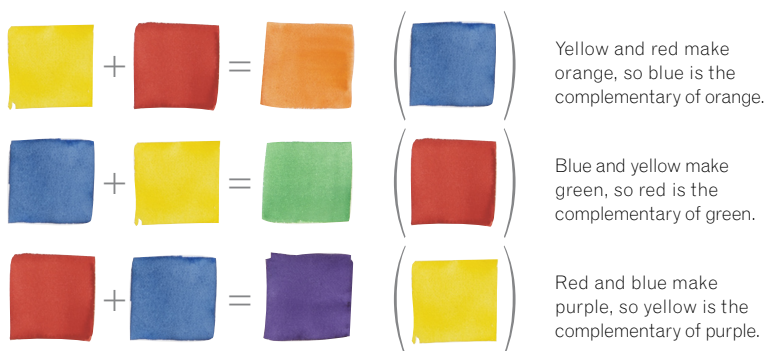
Vibrant colors

To create a really vibrant painting, you need to plan which colors to use. If you try to reproduce all the colors you see in front of you, they end up vying with each other, a bit like all the instruments in an orchestra playing at once. If, on the other hand,

you try limiting the colors you use in a painting to complementary opposites, such as red and green, you will find that the colors make each other appear more vibrant. The reds will look much more red and the greens will appear more intensely green.

COMPLEMENTARY COLORS

There are three primary colors: red, yellow, and blue. These are colors that can't be made by mixing other colors together. Green, orange, and purple are called secondary colors. Each of these is made by mixing two primary colors together. Green, for example, is made by mixing blue and yellow together. Complementary colors are pairs of color that are across from each other on the color wheel. The complementary color of any secondary color, therefore, is the primary color it does not contain.



COLORFUL NEUTRALS

If you mix two complementary colors together in equal proportions, they produce a neutral color. By varying the proportions of the mix, you can create a harmonious range of neutral grays and browns. These neutrals are far more

luminous and colorful than ready-mixed grays and browns, and are excellent for creating areas of tone. If your painting is based around red and green, for example, the areas of tone would be made from varying mixes of red and green.

